ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** cabinets remain largely all-male even when a woman heads the government	The chapter says this
2	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A is false; R is true
3	**(a)** Human rights groups demanding protection of religious minorities	It does not treat one religion above others
4	**(d)** Politics also changes caste identities as caste groups enlarge and form coalitions	Caste gets politicised through political competition
5	**(d)** Making fair representation of women legally binding	Reservation in panchayats is an example
6	**(c)** ST (45.8) was higher than SC (35.9)	All groups were 27.0
7	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Candidates need support of several castes
8	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Household responsibilities limit participation
9	**(c)** Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023	It also covers the Delhi Assembly
10	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Unpaid work is not recognised

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Politics is about power (1); Gender division involves unequal power between men and women (1).	1+1
12	It kills and displaces people (1); It destroys trust among communities (1).	1+1
13	It ensures representation of weaker sections (1); They get a voice in local decisions (1).	1+1
14	Backward caste groups (1); Forward caste groups (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Women agitated for voting rights (1); Legal status and opportunities improved (1); Reservation in local bodies came as a result (1).	1+1+1
16	High participation in Sweden, Norway and Finland (1); India is among the bottom group in the world (1); India lags behind several developing countries too (1).	1+1+1
17	People of different religions are treated as separate nations (1); Leads to exclusion and conflict (1); Northern Ireland shows the dangers (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Constitutional bans are not enough (1); Social change is slow (1); Caste prejudice continues (1).	1+1+1
18	Economic interests differ (1); Men and women of the same caste vote differently (1); They assess governments differently (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Every adult has one vote (1); Leaders needed support of numerous voters (1); New consciousness among low castes (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Education: lower literacy and dropout (1); Work: unequal wages despite 1976 Act and unpaid housework (1); Safety and sex ratio issues (1); Politics: low representation (1); Remedies: reservation and laws (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: India has no official religion (1); Sri Lanka protects Buddhism (1); Pakistan gives special status to Islam (1); England gives special status to Christianity (1); India guarantees freedom to profess, practise and propagate (1).	1+1+1+1+1

20	Gender: positive, women gained rights (1); Religion: communal politics is harmful (1); Caste: gives space to the disadvantaged but can divert attention (1); Healthy expression gives voice without hostility (1); The test is whether it respects equality (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Changes through urbanisation, education, mobility (1); Constitution bans discrimination (1); Yet most marry within caste (1); Untouchability persists (1); Caste linked to poverty and wealth (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** economic condition shapes voting along with caste	Interests differ within a caste
2	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both true; R does not explain A
3	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Caste composition matters
4	**(a)** Other castes also decide the result	No constituency has a single-caste majority
5	**(d)** disadvantaged groups benefit when social divisions become political issues	Women's gains came through political pressure
6	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Other issues get neglected
7	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Upbringing creates roles
8	**(c)** Reservation for backward classes	The rest are mentioned
9	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A is false; R is true
10	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A is false because women are paid less; R is true

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Caste continues to affect economic status (1); Ignoring it would not remove domination (1).	1+1
12	They feel insecure or dominated (1); Communal mind seeks dominance or separation (1).	1+1
13	To become a larger bloc (1); To gain more political bargaining power (1).	1+1
14	It is also political as it needs policies and laws (1); Women's well-being is a public issue (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Women are half of the population (1); Their issues get attention only if they are represented (1); Reservation shows how law can help (1).	1+1+1
16	It gives space for disadvantaged groups (1); Exclusive focus can be unhealthy (1); So the effect is mixed (1).	1+1+1
17	One religion presented as superior (1); Demands formed in opposition to another group (1); State power used to establish dominance (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Women's household work is work (1); It is unpaid and invisible (1); Recognising it affects policy (1).	1+1+1
18	Caste in politics: castes used for votes (1); Politics in caste: politics changes caste identities (1); Caste groups enlarge and make coalitions (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Records religion of every person every ten years (1); Gives reliable information on proportions (1); Shows that proportions have not changed much (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Everyday prejudice, dominance, mobilisation, violence (1); Constitution has no state religion (1); Guarantees freedom of religion (1); Prejudice exists in daily life (1); Religion-based mobilisation must be countered in politics (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: One-third in local bodies (1); Over 10 lakh women representatives (1); Lok Sabha women 14.36 per cent in 2019 (1); State Assemblies below 5 per cent (1); Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam gives 33 per cent (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Parties consider caste in nominations (1); Appeals to caste sentiment (1); Caste groups enlarge and form coalitions (1); No constituency has a single caste majority (1); Voters also consider performance and party (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: Social diversity does not threaten democracy (1); Disadvantaged groups benefit when divisions are expressed (1); Women, Dalits and OBCs gained voice (1); Communal politics shows the risks (1); A democracy must manage differences peacefully (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	These changes weaken hierarchy
2	**(c)** (i) only	India has no official religion
3	**(d)** a large share of that caste's voters support the party	No party wins all votes of a caste
4	**(c)** A and C	Communalism denies B and D
5	**(c)** 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D	Definitions in the exercises
6	**(c)** A is true but R is false.	A is true; R is false because caste is not the only aspect
7	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Disadvantaged groups gain voice
8	**(d)** (ii) and (iii) only	Gender is social
9	**(c)** A is true but R is false.	A is true; R is false because there is no official religion
10	**(b)** Ruling parties and sitting MPs often lose elections	If castes were frozen in preference this would not happen

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Quest of the majority community for political dominance (1); It disregards the minority (1).	1+1
12	Parties consider the dominant caste of a constituency (1); They hope to secure votes (1).	1+1
13	Constitution alone is not enough (1); Prejudice must be countered everywhere (1).	1+1
14	Men are valued more than women (1); Patriarchy gives men power over women (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Rich and poor are found in every caste (1); But lowest castes have higher poverty (1); Upper castes are over-represented among the rich (1).	1+1+1
16	People have varied roles and identities (1); Interests differ by class, gender and region (1); All voices have a right to be heard (1).	1+1+1
17	Human rights groups demand special steps (1); Protection of religious minorities (1); Counter propaganda and prejudice (1).	1+1+1
	OR: No official religion (1); Freedom to profess, practise and propagate (1); State intervenes only to ensure equality, not to oppose religion (1).	1+1+1
18	Family laws vary by religion (1); Women's movement says all discriminate against women (1); Government should make them equitable (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Some castes had access to education under the old system (1); Others were prohibited (1); Those groups lag behind (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Phule, Gandhiji, Ambedkar and Periyar worked for equality (1); Constitution prohibited caste discrimination (1); Policies laid foundations to reverse injustice (1); Urbanisation and education helped (1); Yet inequalities persist (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Caste regulated access to land and education (1); Today caste-based inequality is outlawed (1); Average economic status follows old hierarchy (1); Poverty higher among ST and SC (1); Upper castes over-represented among rich (1).	1+1+1+1+1

20	Legitimate: Gandhiji's ethics, demands to protect minorities, reforming family laws (1); Political acts are not wrong if they treat all religions equally (1); Illegitimate: religion presented as superior (1); State power used for domination (1); Mobilisation by fear (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Each community's number increased but proportions stable (1); Hindus, Jains and Christians declined marginally; Muslims, Sikhs, Buddhists rose slightly (1); Mistaken belief that Muslims will overtake others (1); Sachar Committee estimate: rise of 3 to 4 per cent in 50 years (1); Balance is unlikely to change greatly (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND